

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism - Complete Topic Package

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 Method, Approach and the Methodological Turn | 2 Empirical and Normative Inquiry by Content |
| 3 Traditional Approaches and Their Thinkers | 4 Illustrations, Comparison and Trap Repair |
| 5 Boundaries, Revision and Source Discipline | 6 Behaviouralism's Eight Tenets |
| 7 Post-Behavioural Relevance and Action | 8 Easton and Almond: Systems and Structural Functions |
| 9 Deutsch, Decision-Making, Marxian Analysis and Model Comparison | 10 Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers |

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism - Complete Topic Package

Subject: Political Theory **Section:** Subject-wide Syllabus **Generation:** learner-v2:g2 **Ownership:** supplementary conceptual support; no synthetic GS or Optional PYQ ownership is created. **Source policy:** complete Basic owner first; optional Advanced depth only after practice.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS ANCHOR - ECINET AND ELECTION DATA

FACT: Fact (Election Commission of India/PIB, 8 May 2026): The Election Commission published Assembly-election and bye-election Index Cards and fourteen statistical reports through ECINET within 72 hours of the declaration of results. The reports include constituency-level information on electors, turnout, gender participation, parties and candidates, and were released to improve transparency and data access for researchers, academia and the public.

ANALYSIS: Political-theory use: ECINET can illustrate behavioural data, Easton's outputs-and-feedback logic and Deutsch's communication lens. It does not prove that more data are politically neutral or sufficient: post-behavioural analysis still asks whether evidence addresses inclusion, accountability and significant public problems.

Official source: <https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2258991&lang=1®=3> **ECI reports:** <https://www.eci.gov.in/statistical-reports>

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

SESSION 1 - Method, Approach and the Methodological Turn

Subject: Political Theory | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS/Optional relevance:** GS-II (Polity & Governance) conceptual foundation; PSIR Optional Paper-1 background. **Core area:** How political inquiry is framed-method, approach, facts, values, and the rise of behavioural and post-behavioural analysis. **Grounded in:** O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.4, PDF pp.108-134. **Source edition/cutoff:** Fifth Edition (2009); no post-2009 fact is assumed unless independently dated and tagged **CURRENT:**. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference/synthesis | **CURRENT:** = dated current anchor | **WRONG:** = trap/misattribution. *Companion:* Political-Theory/advanced/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md.

1. One-screen conceptual map

- **FACT:** Method means procedure of inquiry; approach means procedure plus criteria for selecting problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
- **FACT:** Traditional and contemporary are historical labels; they do not exactly coincide with normative and empirical. (PDF pp.109-110)
- **FACT:** Empirical inquiry studies what can be observed and tested; normative inquiry judges what ought to be preferred or prescribed. (PDF pp.110-112)
- **FACT:** Behaviouralism pushed political science toward scientific study of actual political behaviour, regularities, verification and quantification. (PDF pp.118-121)
- **FACT:** Post-behaviouralism kept scientific gains but demanded relevance, action and value-conscious responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)
- **ANALYSIS:** UPSC key: this topic tells you not only what politics is, but how different scholars choose to study it.

2. Why this topic matters

- **FACT:** Gauba shows that disputes in political theory are often methodological before they become ideological. (PDF pp.108-122)
- **FACT:** It helps distinguish description from prescription without collapsing one into the other. (PDF pp.110-112)

- FACT: It introduces the major traditional approaches-philosophical, historical, legal and institutional-and the later behavioural turn. (PDF pp.112-122)
- ANALYSIS: This topic directly extends the theory/science distinction mapped for the module in Political-Theory/README.md and Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md.
- ANALYSIS: In Optional answers, clean method language often separates average answers from high-scoring answers.

SESSION 2 - Empirical and Normative Inquiry by Content

3. Essential definitions

Term	Exam-ready meaning
Method	FACT: The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained. (PDF p.108)
Approach	FACT: A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data. (PDF pp.108-109)
Empirical statement	FACT: A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation. (PDF pp.110-111)
Normative statement	FACT: A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed. (PDF pp.110-112)
Behaviouralism	FACT: A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups. (PDF pp.118-121)
Post-behaviouralism	FACT: A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values. (PDF pp.121-122)

4. Core argument / chapter spine

- FACT: Gauba begins by separating method from approach so that students do not confuse tools of inquiry with frames of inquiry. (PDF pp.108-109)
- FACT: He then warns that traditional/contemporary and normative/empirical are not identical pairs. (PDF pp.109-110)
- FACT: He clarifies that empirical vs normative turns on the content of the claim, not just the grammatical presence of "is" or "ought". (PDF pp.110-112)
- FACT: The traditional approaches are then outlined: philosophical, historical, legal and institutional. (PDF pp.112-117)
- FACT: The contemporary shift is marked by behaviouralism, post-behaviouralism and several models of political analysis. (PDF pp.117-134)
- ANALYSIS: The chapter's deeper message is integrative: political science is weakened both by value-blind technique and by unsupported moral assertion.

SESSION 3 - Traditional Approaches and Their Thinkers

5. Essential distinctions

- FACT: Method vs approach: methods obtain and use data; approaches decide which questions and data count as relevant. (PDF pp.108-109)
- FACT: Traditional vs contemporary: the first cluster is associated with philosophy, history, law and institutions, while the second focuses more on process, behaviour and analysis models. (PDF pp.109-110, 117-118)
- FACT: Empirical vs normative: empirical asks what is observable and testable; normative asks what is right, just or preferable. (PDF pp.110-112)
- FACT: Form vs content: a sentence using "ought" may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition, while a sentence using "is" may still be normative if it defines a value like justice. (PDF pp.110-111)

- FACT: Pure science vs relevance: behaviouralism stressed reliable inquiry; post-behaviouralism added action and public responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)

6. Thinkers and positions

Thinker / stream	Position in this chapter
Vernon Van Dyke	FACT: Clarifies the distinction between approach and method and explains philosophical analysis as conceptual clarification plus evaluation. (PDF pp.108-109, 113)
Leo Strauss	FACT: Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality. (PDF pp.112, 114, 121)
Graham Wallas and Arthur Bentley	FACT: Early forerunners of behaviouralism who shift attention toward actual behaviour and informal processes. (PDF p.118)
Charles Merriam	FACT: Calls for scientific rigour, interdisciplinarity and behavioural inquiry. (PDF pp.118-119)
Harold Lasswell	FACT: Develops politics as the analysis of power and policy. (PDF p.119)
David Easton	FACT: Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action. (PDF pp.120-122)

SESSION 4 - Illustrations, Comparison and Trap Repair

7. Illustrative examples

- FACT: "Everybody ought to vote if democracy is to work" is empirical in content because its claim can be checked against political functioning. (PDF pp.110-111)
- FACT: "Justice is treating equals equally..." is normative in content even though it appears in the form of an "is" statement. (PDF p.110)
- FACT: Legal analysis of Indian politics would ask what constitutional provisions authorize institutions and actions. (PDF pp.115-116)
- FACT: Institutional analysis would map legislature, executive, judiciary, parties and their formal relations. (PDF pp.116-117)
- ANALYSIS: Behavioural analysis of the same political scene would ask how voters, leaders, parties and interest groups actually behave.

8. Comparison table

Semantic table split - Approach cluster

- **Approach cluster:** Traditional
- **Core claim:** FACT: Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions. (PDF pp.109-117)
- **Main focus:** FACT: Concepts, thought, legal framework, institutions. (PDF pp.113-117)
- **Limitation flagged by Gauba:** FACT: Often descriptive or normative without enough behavioural/process analysis. (PDF pp.117-118)
- **Approach cluster:** Behavioural
- **Core claim:** FACT: Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification. (PDF pp.118-121)
- **Main focus:** FACT: Individuals, attitudes, participation, communication, decision-processes. (PDF pp.119-121)
- **Limitation flagged by Gauba:** FACT: Risk of excessive micro-focus, method-fetish and value-neutral distance from urgent public issues. (PDF pp.121-122)
- **Approach cluster:** Post-behavioural

- **Core claim:** FACT: Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction. (PDF pp.121-122)
- **Main focus:** FACT: Social problems, public responsibility, applied knowledge. (PDF pp.121-122)
- **Limitation flagged by Gauba:** ANALYSIS: It must not become a licence for untested moralism; relevance still needs disciplined inquiry.

SESSION 5 - Boundaries, Revision and Source Discipline

9. UPSC traps and corrections

- WRONG: Method and approach are synonyms. -> FACT: Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
- WRONG: Traditional always means normative, and contemporary always means empirical. -> FACT: Gauba explicitly rejects that mechanical equation. (PDF pp.109-110)
- WRONG: Any sentence with "ought" is normative. -> FACT: Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
- WRONG: Value-free means politically consequence-free. -> FACT: Behavioural inquiry can shape what gets studied and ignored, which is why post-behaviouralism raised the issue of relevance. (PDF pp.121-122)
- WRONG: Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for activism. -> FACT: Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122)

10. Cross-links and boundaries

- FACT: Sections 13-19 of this file already reconstruct the eight behavioural tenets and all five analytical models (Easton, Almond, Deutsch, decision-making, Marxian) with claim->evidence->significance->limit; use `Political-Theory/advanced/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md` only for further comparative depth and extra answer-engine prompts, not as a requirement for full marks.
- ANALYSIS: Read `Political-Theory/basic/07_Nature-of-Politics-and-Communitarianism.md` first if the nature of politics itself is unclear.
- ANALYSIS: Use `Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md` for the module-wide theory/science decode engine.
- ANALYSIS: Use `Political-Theory/README.md` for the topic map and tag policy.
- ANALYSIS: Boundary: this file explains ways of studying politics; it does not duplicate detailed constitutional or public-administration content.

11. Revision capsule / answer spine

- FACT: Method = procedure; approach = procedure plus problem/data selection. (PDF pp.108-109)
- FACT: Empirical vs normative depends on content, not grammar alone. (PDF pp.110-112)
- FACT: Traditional approaches: philosophical, historical, legal, institutional. (PDF pp.112-117)
- FACT: Behaviouralism: scientific study of actual behaviour, eight key tenets, micro-level reliability. (PDF pp.118-121)
- FACT: Post-behaviouralism: relevance, action and responsible value concern without discarding scientific gains. (PDF pp.121-122)
- ANALYSIS: Best answer line: political inquiry needs both disciplined evidence and defensible value judgment.

12. Sources, metadata and tags

- FACT: Primary source used directly: Gauba, Ch.4, especially PDF pp.108-122 for basic distinctions and the behavioural/post-behavioural debate.
- FACT: Traditional-approach anchor pages: PDF pp.113-117.
- FACT: Behavioural anchor pages: PDF pp.118-121.
- FACT: Post-behavioural anchor pages: PDF pp.121-122.
- FACT: This basic file reconstructs behaviouralism's eight tenets and all five analytical models (systems, structural-functional, communications/cybernetic, decision-making, Marxian) directly, so it is independently

sufficient for full-mark answers; the advanced companion adds further comparative depth and answer-engine prompts.

SESSION 6 - Behaviouralism's Eight Tenets

13. Behaviouralism's eight commonly taught tenets (provenance caution)

- ANALYSIS: These eight "tenets"/"intellectual foundation stones" are commonly attributed, via Gauba's exposition, to **David Easton's** account of behaviouralism (echoing Easton's own 1969 listing). Treat the list below as a widely used pedagogical summary rather than a verbatim quotation of any single sentence:
- 1. **Regularities** - political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.
- 2. **Verification** - those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.
- 3. **Techniques** - rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.
- 4. **Quantification** - precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.
- 5. **Values** - an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).
- 6. **Systematization** - research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.
- 7. **Pure science** - understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.
- 8. **Integration** - political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.
- ANALYSIS: Exam use: naming these eight in order and pairing two or three with a one-line illustration (e.g. quantification -> voting-behaviour surveys; integration -> borrowing psychology for leadership studies) earns more marks than a vague "behaviouralism is scientific" line.

SESSION 7 - Post-Behavioural Relevance and Action

14. Post-behaviouralism: relevance and action

- FACT: Post-behaviouralism, associated with Easton's own self-correction, retains the scientific gains of behaviouralism (rigour, verification, technique) but adds two demands: **relevance** - political science must address urgent public problems (war, poverty, discrimination, injustice) rather than only tractable micro-questions - and **action** - intellectuals bear responsibility to apply knowledge for social betterment, not merely to accumulate value-neutral findings. (PDF pp.121-122)
- ANALYSIS: Post-behaviouralism is a corrective *within* science, not a licence for unexamined activism; relevance still requires disciplined evidence, or it collapses back into the untested moralism political science was trying to escape.

SESSION 8 - Easton and Almond: Systems and Structural Functions

15. The five analytical models (direct reconstruction)

1. **David Easton - systems analysis**
 - **Claim:** the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing **inputs** (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a **conversion process** (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into **outputs** (policies, decisions), which generate **feedback** that reshapes future demands and supports.
 - **Evidence/mechanism:** stability is explained by the system's capacity to convert demands into outputs faster than demands accumulate, and by supports (loyalty, legitimacy, taxes, compliance) that keep the conversion process running.
 - **Significance:** allows comparison across very different polities using one common vocabulary (inputs/outputs/feedback), and foregrounds system persistence and adaptation.

- **Limit:** criticised as too static/equilibrium-biased; weak at explaining the internal distribution of power, ideology, or discontinuous change such as revolution, and thin on why particular actors win particular conflicts.

2. Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach

- **Claim:** every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal **functions** (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different **structures** in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another).
- **Evidence/mechanism:** comparing systems by function rather than by formal institutional labels lets scholars compare, say, a parliamentary democracy and a traditional chiefdom on the same functional grid.
- **Significance:** widened comparative politics beyond formal constitutions to informal structures, especially useful for newly independent/developing polities whose formal institutions may not match Western templates.
- **Limit:** functionalism's assumption that systems tend toward equilibrium risks a conservative bias (downplaying conflict and structural change), and in practice often measured non-Western systems against a Western liberal-democratic benchmark despite the framework's own claim to be structure-neutral.

SESSION 9 - Deutsch, Decision-Making, Marxian Analysis and Model Comparison

3. Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach

- **Claim:** government functions like a **steering mechanism**, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals.
- **Evidence/mechanism:** concepts such as information "load," "lag," "gain" and "lead" describe how efficiently a political system receives, processes and acts on information about the gap between its goals and its actual performance.
- **Significance:** foregrounds learning, error-correction and adaptive capacity in political systems, useful for analysing bureaucratic responsiveness and policy feedback.
- **Limit:** the mechanistic/engineering metaphor understates power, ideology and class conflict, and is not well suited to explaining revolution, resource allocation battles or the use of violence.

4. Decision-making approach

- **Claim:** political outcomes are best explained by identifying the **decision-makers**, the **alternatives** before them, and the **information, values and organisational setting** that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.
- **Evidence/mechanism:** decision-making frameworks (e.g. those used in foreign-policy analysis) break a decision into stages - problem recognition, search for alternatives, evaluation, choice, and implementation - and examine the internal organisational context of the deciding body.
- **Significance:** useful for tracing why one policy alternative rather than another was actually chosen, spotlighting individuals and institutions as choosers rather than treating outcomes as automatic system outputs.
- **Limit:** can become narrowly focused on the moment of decision, losing sight of long-term structural forces (class, economy, ideology) that pre-shape which alternatives even reach the table; risks elite bias by concentrating only on visible decision-makers.

5. Marxian approach

- **Claim:** politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a **superstructure** resting on, and reproducing, the economic **base**/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class.
- **Evidence/mechanism:** analysis of who owns and controls the means of production is used to explain apparently neutral political institutions (law, bureaucracy, even ideology) as expressions of underlying class interest.
- **Significance:** exposes hidden class interests behind formally neutral institutions and connects political analysis directly to economic structure.

- **Limit:** reductionist - denies political institutions and ideas any independent causal weight of their own; struggles to explain variation among different capitalist states with similar economic structures but very different politics; its historical predictions about revolutionary transition remain contested and should be treated as book-period theoretical claims, not settled fact. (PDF pp.133-134, per the advanced companion's reconstruction)

16. Comparing the five models and their limitations

Semantic table split - Model

- **Model:** Systems (Easton)
- **Core unit of analysis:** Inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback
- **Main strength:** Cross-system comparison; explains persistence/stability
- **Main limitation:** Weak on power distribution and revolutionary change
- **Model:** Structural-functional (Almond)
- **Core unit of analysis:** Functions performed by variable structures
- **Main strength:** Compares formal and informal/traditional structures
- **Main limitation:** Conservative/equilibrium bias; implicit Western benchmark
- **Model:** Communications/cybernetic (Deutsch)
- **Core unit of analysis:** Information flow and feedback
- **Main strength:** Explains learning, adaptation, error-correction
- **Main limitation:** Understates power, ideology, class conflict
- **Model:** Decision-making
- **Core unit of analysis:** Decision-makers, alternatives, choice process
- **Main strength:** Explains specific policy choices
- **Main limitation:** Narrow focus; elite bias; misses structural forces
- **Model:** Marxian
- **Core unit of analysis:** Economic base and class relations
- **Main strength:** Exposes hidden class interest in institutions
- **Main limitation:** Reductionist; weak on inter-capitalist variation
- **ANALYSIS:** Exam framing: no single model is "correct" - Gauba's own comparative stance (echoed in §8 above for the traditional/behavioural/post-behavioural clusters) extends here: each model highlights different variables (stability, function, communication, choice, or class) and is chosen according to the question asked, not treated as a universal master key.

SESSION 10 - Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers

17. Two objection-reply chains

1. **Objection:** behavioural political science's value-neutrality claim makes it complicit in ignoring urgent injustice, since choosing what to study/ignore is itself a value-laden act.

Reply: post-behaviouralism (Easton) does not abandon science in response; it insists that knowledge must be made relevant and put to responsible use while retaining verification and rigour - "action" is added to, not substituted for, evidence standards. (PDF pp.121-122)

2. **Objection:** structural-functionalism's claim to be structure-neutral is not honoured in practice - comparative studies routinely measure non-Western/developing polities against an implicit Western liberal-democratic template and label divergence as "underdevelopment."

Reply: defenders reply that the framework's functional categories (interest articulation, aggregation, rule-making, etc.) are, by design, meant to be filled by any structure - formal parties or informal kinship/patron-client networks alike - so the bias is a failure of *application*, not of the model's own logic; critics maintain the correction is inconsistently applied in comparative practice. **ANALYSIS:** Present both sides; do not resolve the debate as settled.

18. Cautious Indian application

- ANALYSIS: The decision-making approach can be used to analyse how an Indian policy choice (e.g. a Cabinet or Cabinet Committee decision) moves from problem recognition to implementation, without asserting unverified specifics of any particular real decision unless independently confirmed.
- ANALYSIS: The structural-functional approach can compare India's formal parliamentary structures with informal interest-articulation channels (caste associations, kinship networks, local patron-client ties) performing the same function in different areas - cite this as a *type* of comparison, not with unverified statistics.
- ANALYSIS: The systems model can be used to trace how a sustained public demand (e.g. a farmers' agitation) moves through the input-conversion-output-feedback cycle into policy - use as a conceptual illustration, not as a claim about any specific outcome unless separately verified.

19. Executable answer architecture (10/15/20 marks)

Directive decoding

- "Discuss behaviouralism as an approach to political analysis" -> requires definition + the eight tenets (at least several named) + a limitation, not a one-line description.
- "Explain any one model of political analysis" -> single-model directive: give claim, mechanism, significance and limitation for that one model only; do not pad with unrelated models.
- "Compare/Distinguish [any two models]" -> comparison directive: use the comparison table logic (unit of analysis, strength, limitation) explicitly for both named models.

10-mark architecture (~150 words)

1. Thesis: political inquiry has moved from traditional/normative approaches to a scientific, and then a value-conscious, contemporary approach.
2. Body: name behaviouralism's core aim + 2-3 of the eight tenets, or reconstruct one analytical model with claim->evidence->significance.
3. One limitation.
4. One-line conclusion.

15-mark architecture (~200-250 words)

1. Thesis + directive decoding.
2. Doctrine reconstruction: method vs approach -> empirical vs normative -> traditional approaches in one line -> behaviouralism's eight tenets (name at least four) -> post-behaviouralism's relevance/action correction.
3. Reconstruct one analytical model in full (claim->evidence->significance->limit).
4. One objection-reply chain.
5. Reasoned conclusion.

20-mark architecture (~250-300 words)

1. Thesis + directive decoding.
2. Full doctrine reconstruction: method/approach, empirical/normative, traditional approaches, behaviouralism's eight tenets, post-behaviouralism.
3. Reconstruct at least two analytical models (e.g. Easton's systems model and Almond's structural-functional approach, or Deutsch's cybernetic model and the Marxian approach) with claim->evidence->significance->limit each, plus the comparison table's logic.
4. Two objection-reply chains (value-neutrality objection; structural-functional Western-benchmark objection).
5. Cautious Indian application (one example, correctly hedged).
6. Graded conclusion on why political science needs both scientific rigour and relevance/value-consciousness.

Quotation/proposition method

- Prefer named propositions over unverified verbatim quotations, e.g. "*Easton's proposition that political science should integrate scientific rigour with relevance and action*" rather than an exact quoted sentence, unless independently verified.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Method**?

A. The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained. B. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values. C. those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour. D. understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Method** with **The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.**

A. Integration B. Method C. Marxian approach D. Empirical statement

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.** with **Method**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Approach**?

A. Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions. B. rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data. C. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data. D. political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Approach** with **A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.**

A. David Easton - systems analysis B. Leo Strauss C. Normative statement D. Approach

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.** with **Approach**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Empirical statement**?

A. A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation. B. Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification. C. precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it. D. the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies,

decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Empirical statement** with **A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.**

A. Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach B. Empirical statement C. David Easton D. Behaviouralism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.** with **Empirical statement.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Normative statement?**

A. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction. B. an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference). C. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed. D. every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Normative statement** with **A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.**

A. Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach B. Method C. Post-behaviouralism D. Normative statement

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.** with **Normative statement.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Behaviouralism?**

A. A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups. B. political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories. C. research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory. D. government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Behaviouralism** with **A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups..** The other options are valid source

terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.**

A. Decision-making approach B. Behaviouralism C. Approach D. Traditional

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.** with **Behaviouralism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Post-behaviouralism**?

A. those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour. B. understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems. C. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values. D. political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Post-behaviouralism** with **A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.**

A. Marxian approach B. Empirical statement C. Behavioural D. Post-behaviouralism

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.** with **Post-behaviouralism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Traditional**?

A. Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions. B. rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data. C. political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences. D. politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Traditional** with **Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.**

A. Leo Strauss B. Traditional C. Normative statement D. Post-behavioural

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.** with **Traditional.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Behavioural**?

A. precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it. B. the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports. C. Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification. D. Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Behavioural** with **Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification.**

A. David Easton B. Behaviouralism C. Regularities D. Behavioural

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification.** with **Behavioural.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Post-behavioural**?

A. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction. B. an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference). C. every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another). D. Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Post-behavioural** with **Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.**

A. Method B. Post-behavioural C. Post-behaviouralism D. Verification

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.** with **Post-behavioural.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Regularities**?

A. research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory. B. government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals. C. political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories. D. The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Regularities** with **political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories**.

A. Approach B. Traditional C. Techniques D. Regularities

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories** with **Regularities**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Verification**?

A. those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour. B. understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems. C. political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice. D. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Verification** with **those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour**.

A. Empirical statement B. Verification C. Behavioural D. Quantification

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour** with **Verification**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Techniques**?

A. political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences. B. politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class. C. rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data. D. A claim about an

observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Techniques** with **rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.**

A. Normative statement B. Post-behavioural C. Values D. Techniques

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.** with **Techniques**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Quantification**?

A. precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it. B. the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports. C. Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality. D. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Quantification** with **precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.**

A. Behaviouralism B. Quantification C. Regularities D. Systematization

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.** with **Quantification**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Values**?

A. every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another). B. Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action. C. an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference). D. A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Values** with **an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).** The other options are valid

source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference)**.

A. Post-behaviouralism B. Verification C. Pure science D. Values

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference)**. with **Values**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Systematization**?

A. research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory. B. government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals. C. The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained. D. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Systematization** with **research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.**

A. Traditional B. Systematization C. Techniques D. Integration

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.** with **Systematization**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Pure science**?

A. political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice. B. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data. C. understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems. D. Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Pure science** with **understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social**

problems.

A. Behavioural B. Quantification C. David Easton - systems analysis D. Pure science

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.** with **Pure science.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Integration**?

A. political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences. B. politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class. C. A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation. D. Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Integration** with **political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.**

A. Post-behavioural B. Integration C. Values D. Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.** with **Integration.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **David Easton - systems analysis**?

A. Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality. B. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed. C. the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports. D. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **David Easton - systems analysis** with **the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and**

supports.

A. Regularities B. Systematization C. Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach D. David Easton - systems analysis

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports.** with **David Easton - systems analysis**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach**?

A. every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another). B. Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action. C. A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups. D. political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach** with **every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another).**

A. Verification B. Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach C. Pure science D. Decision-making approach

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another).** with **Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach**?

A. The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained. B. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values. C. government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting

the system's course toward its goals. D. those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach** with **government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals.**

A. Techniques B. Integration C. Marxian approach D. Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **government functions like a steering mechanism, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals.** with **Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Decision-making approach**?

A. political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice. B. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data. C. Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions. D. rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Decision-making approach** with **political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.**

A. Quantification B. Decision-making approach C. David Easton - systems analysis D. Leo Strauss

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.** with **Decision-making approach.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Marxian approach**?

A. A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation. B. Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification. C. politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class. D. precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marxian approach** with **politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class.**

A. Values B. Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach C. David Easton D. Marxian approach

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class.** with **Marxian approach.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Leo Strauss**?

A. Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality. B. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed. C. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction. D. an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Leo Strauss** with **Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.**

A. Systematization B. Leo Strauss C. Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach D. Method

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.** with **Leo Strauss.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **David Easton**?

A. A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups. B. political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories. C. Gives both the

behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action. D. research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **David Easton** with **Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.**

A. Pure science B. Decision-making approach C. Approach D. David Easton

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.** with **David Easton.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ STATUS

No directly owned verified UPSC PYQ is assigned to this Political Theory topic. Political Theory is a conceptual-support repository, and the source mapping expressly prohibits proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ routing. The questions below are therefore labelled as original practice, not PYQs.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish method from approach in political inquiry and explain why the distinction matters. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Method and approach both organise inquiry, but they operate at different levels.

Core analysis: A method is a procedure for obtaining, testing and interpreting knowledge, such as observation, comparison, historical reconstruction or statistical analysis. An approach is wider: it includes methods but also criteria for selecting the problem, relevant actors, admissible data and explanatory variables. A behavioural approach, for example, directs attention toward observable conduct and may then use surveys or quantification as methods. A philosophical approach selects conceptual coherence and normative justification as central problems and uses argument as a method. Vernon Van Dyke's distinction therefore prevents tools from being confused with intellectual frames.

Critical evaluation: Methods are not neutral instruments floating outside an approach, because the choice of data already reflects a view of what matters. Yet the distinction remains analytically useful: approaches set the agenda, while methods make investigation disciplined and publicly testable.

Conclusion: The distinction matters because method governs the reliability of inquiry, whereas approach also governs its intellectual agenda by deciding which problems, actors and evidence become visible.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why must empirical and normative statements be classified by content rather than grammatical form? Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Empirical and normative statements differ by the kind of claim they make, not simply by whether their wording contains 'is' or 'ought'.

Core analysis: An empirical statement describes an observable relation that can be checked through evidence, repetition or consequences. A normative statement expresses a value, obligation or preferred order and requires moral justification. Gauba's examples expose the grammatical trap. 'Everybody ought to vote if democracy is to work' can be empirical in content because the proposed condition may be tested against democratic functioning. A definition such as 'justice is treating equals equally' may use 'is' while still expressing a normative standard. Instrumental prescriptions can therefore be empirical, and descriptive-looking definitions can be evaluative.

Critical evaluation: Evidence cannot by itself prove an ultimate moral end, while moral language cannot shield a factual claim from testing. Correct classification requires asking whether the claim is verifiable, evaluative or a combination requiring both forms of reasoning.

Conclusion: Political analysis must test what kind of claim is being made rather than searching mechanically for 'is' or 'ought', because factual conditions can be phrased prescriptively and value judgments descriptively.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Examine behaviouralism's eight tenets and its contribution to political science. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Behaviouralism reoriented political science toward the systematic study of actual political behaviour rather than exclusive reliance on formal institutions or inherited texts.

Core analysis: Its commonly taught Eastonian tenets are regularities, verification, techniques, quantification, value separation, systematization, pure science and integration. Regularities make generalisation possible; verification tests claims against observation; techniques and quantification improve precision; value separation distinguishes empirical explanation from ethical judgment; systematization connects theory and research; pure science gives explanation logical priority over application; and integration opens political science to other social sciences. Wallas, Bentley, Merriam and Lasswell prepared this movement by studying psychology, groups, power and policy.

Further development: The tenets are mutually supporting rather than a checklist of isolated slogans. Regularities require verification; verification depends on suitable techniques; quantification is justified only where measurement preserves meaning; and systematization prevents data collection from becoming theory-free. Integration supplies concepts and methods from neighbouring disciplines, while pure science marks an ordering of inquiry rather than a permanent ban on application. The strongest assessment therefore distinguishes behaviouralism's scientific discipline from scientism, the mistaken belief that only measurable questions are politically significant.

Critical evaluation: The contribution was substantial: political inquiry gained clearer hypotheses, comparative data and methodological self-criticism. Its limits were method-fetish, excessive micro-focus and distance from urgent injustice. Scientific rigour enlarged political knowledge, but could not decide which questions deserved priority.

Conclusion: Behaviouralism made political inquiry more systematic, verifiable and interdisciplinary, but its scientific contribution remains defensible only when technique serves significant political questions rather than replacing them.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate post-behaviouralism as a correction of, rather than a rejection of, behaviouralism. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Post-behaviouralism arose from dissatisfaction with behavioural political science's retreat into tractable method while public crises demanded responsible knowledge.

Core analysis: Easton's correction preserved behaviouralism's achievements-regularities, verification, rigorous technique and empirical explanation-but added relevance and action. Relevance requires research to address significant problems such as war, poverty, discrimination and injustice instead of selecting questions only because they are easily measured. Action requires scholars to accept responsibility for applying knowledge toward social betterment. The movement also made value choice explicit: deciding what to study and whom research serves cannot be treated as politically innocent.

Further development: Its correction also changes the scholar's role. Behavioural detachment protects research from propaganda, but detachment cannot mean indifference to how knowledge is selected or used. Relevance identifies important public problems, action connects findings to possible remedies, and value-consciousness requires explicit justification of ends. The residual danger is that urgency may reward weak evidence or ideological certainty. Post-behaviouralism succeeds only when public responsibility is joined to reproducible inquiry and critical scrutiny.

Critical evaluation: This is not permission for unsupported activism. Evidence standards remain necessary, and a fashionable cause does not validate weak analysis. Post-behaviouralism corrects the purpose and public orientation of science; it does not replace verification with conviction. Its durable position is therefore a synthesis of rigour, relevance and accountable action.

Conclusion: Post-behaviouralism is best understood as value-conscious science: it retains verification and technique while restoring relevance, action and public responsibility.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Compare the systems, structural-functional, communications, decision-making and Marxian models of political analysis. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: The five models organise political explanation around different units and mechanisms, so comparison must ask what each reveals and conceals.

Core analysis: Easton's systems analysis traces demands and supports through conversion into outputs and feedback, explaining persistence and adaptation. Almond's structural-functional model compares the universal functions performed by different formal or informal structures. Deutsch's communications model treats government as a steering process dependent on information flow, load, lag and corrective feedback. Decision-making analysis reconstructs who chose among which alternatives under particular informational, value and organisational constraints. Marxian analysis locates institutions and ideas within the economic base, class relations and dominant interests.

Further development: Model choice should follow the explanatory problem. A demand moving through institutions is suited to Easton's input-output-feedback cycle; comparison across unlike formal structures is suited to Almond's functional grid; bureaucratic learning is illuminated by Deutsch's information flows; a discrete policy choice requires decision-process reconstruction; and concealed ownership power calls for Marxian analysis. Objections also differ: systems and functionalism are criticised for stability bias, communications for underplaying conflict, decision-making for ignoring pre-structured alternatives, and Marxism for economic reductionism. Triangulating models can test whether one model's omitted variable changes the conclusion, but models cannot simply be stacked without a clear causal sequence.

Critical evaluation: Systems and functional models can privilege equilibrium; communications language can mechanise politics; decision analysis may become elite-centred and episodic; Marxian analysis may reduce political autonomy to economics. Their strengths are therefore conditional, not cumulative proof of one master model.

Conclusion: The five models should be treated as complementary but limited lenses: each identifies a different causal mechanism, and no one model can explain stability, function, information, choice and class power simultaneously.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Can political science be value-free? Discuss with reference to behaviouralism, Strauss and post-behaviouralism. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: The ideal of value-free political science seeks to protect factual explanation from the researcher's moral preferences, but it cannot remove values from every stage of inquiry.

Core analysis: Behaviouralism usefully separates empirical propositions from ethical evaluation and demands verification, regularity and disciplined technique. This prevents desired conclusions from substituting for evidence. Strauss objects that political inquiry cannot understand tyranny, justice or the good regime while refusing to judge values; selection of politically important problems already presupposes standards of significance. Post-behaviouralism converts that criticism into methodological reform: research must retain scientific rigour while becoming relevant, action-oriented and conscious of its public consequences.

Further development: The empirical-normative distinction should be preserved even when complete neutrality is rejected. Whether turnout changed, an institution complied with a rule or an attitude correlates with behaviour remains an evidential question. Whether participation is adequate, compliance legitimate or an attitude unjust requires evaluative reasons. Strauss protects the latter inquiry; behaviouralism disciplines the former; post-behaviouralism asks how the two can address public problems together. The remaining danger is ideological capture, where relevance becomes an excuse to predetermine findings. Transparent question selection, replicable evidence, explicit value premises and openness to criticism provide a stronger settlement than either scientific withdrawal or untested activism.

Critical evaluation: The distinction between detachment and ethical neutrality is decisive. Scholars should disclose premises, test factual claims and avoid partisan distortion, yet they must still justify why particular ends, harms and exclusions matter. Value control is possible; complete value absence is not.

Conclusion: Political science can discipline factual inquiry against partisan assertion, but it cannot become value-free in its choice of problems, interpretation of significance or judgment of political ends.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Political Theory | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS/Optional relevance:** GS-II (Polity & Governance) conceptual foundation; PSIR Optional Paper-1 background. **Core area:** Competing ways of studying politics-from philosophical and institutional inquiry to behavioural science, post-behavioural relevance and analytical models. **Grounded in:** O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.4, PDF pp.108-134. **Source edition/cutoff:** Fifth Edition (2009); no post-2009 fact is assumed unless independently dated and tagged **CURRENT**: **FACT**: = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS**: = analytical inference/synthesis | **CURRENT**: = dated current anchor | **WRONG**: = trap/misattribution. *Companion:* Political-Theory/basic/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md.

1. One-screen advanced map

- **FACT:** Gauba separates method from approach, then empirical from normative, before classifying the main approaches. (PDF pp.108-112)
- **FACT:** Traditional approaches centre on philosophy, history, law and institutions. (PDF pp.112-117)
- **FACT:** Behaviouralism reorients the discipline toward observable political behaviour, scientific procedure and interdisciplinary tools. (PDF pp.118-121)
- **FACT:** Post-behaviouralism criticizes the withdrawal into pure method and adds relevance, action and value-conscious responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)
- **FACT:** Political analysis then branches into systems, structural-functional, communications, decision-making and Marxian analysis. (PDF pp.122-134)

- ANALYSIS: Topic 08 is the methodological hinge of the module because it tells you how every later topic may be investigated differently.

2. Scope, assumptions and conceptual boundary

- FACT: This chapter is about approaches to inquiry, not a direct substantive theory of liberty, justice or the state. (PDF pp.108-134)
- FACT: Gauba warns against equating empirical with contemporary or normative with traditional in a rigid way. (PDF pp.109-110)
- FACT: He ends by refusing a complete estrangement between empirical and normative inquiry. (PDF p.112)
- ANALYSIS: Conceptually, this topic builds on the module's theory/philosophy/science distinction as mapped in Political-Theory/README.md and organized in Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md.
- ANALYSIS: Boundary: the models here are presented as tools of analysis, not as timeless proofs that one method must replace all others.

3. Direct-book argument reconstruction

- FACT: Gauba begins with conceptual hygiene: method concerns how to inquire, whereas approach concerns both how and what to inquire into. (PDF pp.108-109)
- FACT: He then historicizes the field: pre-Second-World-War approaches are called traditional, while later approaches are contemporary, but this is not the same as facts-versus-values. (PDF pp.109-110)
- FACT: Next he clarifies empirical and normative inquiry by content, showing that verification, sense-experience and instrumental value differ from moral preference and intrinsic value. (PDF pp.110-112)
- FACT: He reconstructs the traditional cluster through four approaches: philosophical, historical, legal and institutional. (PDF pp.112-117)
- FACT: He then narrates behaviouralism as a post-war American movement with earlier roots in Wallas, Bentley and Merriam, eventually summarized by Easton's eight tenets. (PDF pp.118-121)
- FACT: The post-behavioural revolution is presented as Easton's internal correction: keep science, but reconnect it to public crises, values and action. (PDF pp.121-122)
- FACT: Finally, Gauba extends the contemporary chapter into models of analysis-systems, structural-functional, communications, decision-making and Marxian analysis-each highlighting different variables. (PDF pp.122-134)

4. Definitions and distinctions

Distinction	Advanced note
Method / approach	FACT: Methods obtain and use data; approaches choose problems and relevant data as well. (PDF pp.108-109)
Traditional / contemporary	FACT: A historical distinction about dominant styles of inquiry, not a perfect facts-values binary. (PDF pp.109-110)
Empirical / normative	FACT: Empirical claims are observable and testable; normative claims express preferred orders or moral principles. (PDF pp.110-112)
Form / content	FACT: Gauba explicitly shows that the wording "is" or "ought" cannot by itself classify a statement. (PDF pp.110-111)
Value-neutral / value-indifferent	ANALYSIS: Behaviouralism aimed at separating empirical explanation from ethical evaluation, but Gauba's post-behavioural section shows that this never meant the discipline could ignore the consequences of what it chose to study or neglect.

5. Thinker-by-thinker positions

Thinker	Position in this topic
Vernon Van Dyke	FACT: Defines approach as criteria of selection and philosophical analysis as clarification plus evaluation. (PDF pp.108-109, 113)
Leo Strauss	FACT: Reasserts political philosophy as knowledge of facts and standards of the good, and criticizes value-free behaviouralism. (PDF pp.112, 114, 121)
Graham Wallas	FACT: Uses psychology to challenge the overly rational image of man in politics and urges attention to actual behaviour. (PDF p.118)
Arthur Bentley	FACT: Pushes toward analysis of informal group processes rather than institutions in isolation. (PDF p.118)
Charles Merriam	FACT: Calls for scientific rigour, interdisciplinary borrowing and policy-science orientation. (PDF pp.118-119)
G.E.G. Catlin and Harold Lasswell	FACT: Develop value-free power analysis and politics as the study of who gets what, when, how. (PDF p.119)
David Easton	FACT: Defines behavioural tenets, then leads the post-behavioural turn and systems analysis. (PDF pp.120-125)
Gabriel Almond	FACT: Builds structural-functional analysis on the political-system framework. (PDF pp.127-129)
Karl Deutsch	FACT: Turns communication and cybernetics into a model of political analysis. (PDF pp.129-131)
Marx / Engels	FACT: Offer a non-autonomous, base-superstructure analysis in which politics must be traced to class structure. (PDF pp.133-134)

6. Competing perspectives

- FACT: Philosophical approach clarifies concepts and evaluates institutions against standards of the good, right and just. (PDF pp.113-114)
- FACT: Historical approach studies either historical laws/processes or the history of political thought in relation to its context. (PDF pp.114-115)
- FACT: Legal approach studies politics through law, constitutional framework and legally valid authority, while remaining limited in capturing informal forces. (PDF pp.115-116)
- FACT: Institutional approach studies the organization and functioning of government, parties and related institutions, yet risks over-description and neglect of informal processes. (PDF pp.116-117)
- FACT: Behaviouralism privileges observation, regularities, verification, techniques, quantification, value-neutrality, systematization, pure science and integration. (PDF pp.120-121)
- FACT: Post-behaviouralism shifts from knowledge-for-its-own-sake toward relevance, applied knowledge, action and concern with value choice. (PDF pp.121-122)
- FACT: Marxian analysis rejects the autonomy of politics and instead studies its hidden basis in the mode of production and class struggle. (PDF pp.133-134)

7. Internal debates and criticisms

- **FACT:** Gauba records the criticism that behaviouralism privileges reliable micro-level questions over broader but less tractable questions. (PDF p.121)
- **FACT:** Post-behaviouralism arises because excessive methodological sophistication left the discipline distant from war, dictatorship, nuclear threat and urgent public crises. (PDF pp.121-122)
- **FACT:** Legal and institutional approaches remain valuable, but each is limited by relative neglect of informal behaviour, violence, social forces or broader explanation. (PDF pp.116-117)
- **FACT:** Systems analysis is useful comparatively, yet Gauba notes its weakness in analysing political power and mass political behaviour such as voting. (PDF pp.125-126)
- **FACT:** Structural-functional analysis is criticized for conservatism, weak power analysis, and projecting liberal-democratic benchmarks onto developing societies. (PDF p.129)
- **FACT:** Communications theory is useful but limited for ideology, power structure, allocation of resources, violence and revolution. (PDF pp.130-131)
- **WRONG:** Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion. -> **FACT:** Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)

8. Comparative matrix

Semantic table split - Approach

- **Approach:** Philosophical
- **Core question:** **FACT:** What is right, just or conceptually coherent? (PDF pp.113-114)
- **Preferred data or unit:** **FACT:** Concepts, arguments, standards. (PDF pp.113-114)
- **Strength:** **FACT:** Clarifies ends and critiques institutions. (PDF pp.113-114)
- **Limitation:** **ANALYSIS:** Cannot by itself supply behavioural verification.
- **Approach:** Historical
- **Core question:** **FACT:** How did ideas or political processes emerge over time? (PDF pp.114-115)
- **Preferred data or unit:** **FACT:** Past events and texts. (PDF pp.114-115)
- **Strength:** **FACT:** Restores context and continuity. (PDF pp.114-115)
- **Limitation:** **FACT:** Risks living on inherited ideas without new synthesis. (PDF p.115)
- **Approach:** Legal
- **Core question:** **FACT:** What do laws and constitutions authorize? (PDF pp.115-116)
- **Preferred data or unit:** **FACT:** Legal provisions, procedures, judgments. (PDF pp.115-116)
- **Strength:** **FACT:** Captures binding framework and validity. (PDF p.116)
- **Limitation:** **FACT:** Misses extra-legal behaviour and informal forces. (PDF p.116)
- **Approach:** Institutional
- **Core question:** **FACT:** How are political offices and agencies organized and related? (PDF pp.116-117)
- **Preferred data or unit:** **FACT:** Organs of government and parties. (PDF pp.116-117)
- **Strength:** **FACT:** Gives politics disciplinary identity. (PDF p.116)
- **Limitation:** **FACT:** Over-descriptive; neglects informal processes and individuals. (PDF p.117)
- **Approach:** Behavioural
- **Core question:** **FACT:** How do actual actors behave, and what regularities can be found? (PDF pp.118-121)
- **Preferred data or unit:** **FACT:** Voters, leaders, attitudes, participation, quantified data. (PDF pp.119-121)
- **Strength:** **FACT:** Scientific rigour and explanatory ambition. (PDF pp.120-121)
- **Limitation:** **FACT:** Method-heavy, micro-biased, value-neutral. (PDF pp.121-122)
- **Approach:** Post-behavioural
- **Core question:** **FACT:** How can rigorous inquiry address urgent social problems? (PDF pp.121-122)
- **Preferred data or unit:** **FACT:** Behavioural findings plus public problems and value questions. (PDF pp.121-122)

- **Strength:** FACT: Relevance and action. (PDF pp.121-122)
- **Limitation:** ANALYSIS: Can be vague if relevance is asserted without analytical discipline.
- **Approach:** Marxian
- **Core question:** FACT: What class structure and mode of production generate politics? (PDF pp.133-134)
- **Preferred data or unit:** FACT: Economic structure, class relations, historical stages. (PDF pp.133-134)
- **Strength:** FACT: Reveals the hidden basis of politics in class power. (PDF pp.133-134)
- **Limitation:** FACT: Refuses autonomy of politics, so it sidelines system-level analysis per se. (PDF pp.133-134)

9. Application without current-affairs dependence

- ANALYSIS: A university election can be studied philosophically by asking what fair representation requires.
- ANALYSIS: The same election can be studied historically by tracing how student institutions evolved on that campus.
- ANALYSIS: It can be studied legally by examining the rules, eligibility and valid procedures.
- ANALYSIS: It can be studied institutionally by mapping offices, committees and roles.
- ANALYSIS: It can be studied behaviourally by surveying turnout, attitudes, campaigning and peer influence.
- ANALYSIS: It can be studied post-behaviourally by asking whether that knowledge helps solve exclusion, violence or distrust in the institution.
- ANALYSIS: It can be studied through systems analysis as inputs, outputs and feedback, or through decision-making analysis by tracking who chose what among which alternatives.

10. UPSC answer-engine prompts

- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Differentiate method and approach in political science." -> Use Van Dyke first, then show why approach includes criteria of selection.
- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Why is empirical vs normative not identical to contemporary vs traditional?" -> Give Gauba's warning, then cite Aristotle, Marx, Rawls and Hayek as mixed cases. (PDF pp.109-110)
- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Assess behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism." -> Organize by scientific gains, limits, and Easton's relevance-action correction.
- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Explain major models of political analysis." -> Move from Easton to Almond to Deutsch to decision-making, then contrast Marxian analysis.
- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Can political science be value-free?" -> Use behavioural aspiration, Straussian criticism and post-behavioural synthesis.

11. Cross-links and exclusions

- ANALYSIS: Foundation companion:
Political-Theory/basic/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md.
- ANALYSIS: Substantive predecessor:
Political-Theory/basic/07_Nature-of-Politics-and-Communitarianism.md.
- ANALYSIS: Module framework: Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md.
- ANALYSIS: Topic map and tagging discipline: Political-Theory/README.md.
- ANALYSIS: Exclusion: this file does not substitute for later substantive topics on state, power, rights or democracy; it provides the lenses through which those topics can be studied.

12. Factual-risk checks

- FACT: Behaviouralism is described here in its mid-20th-century disciplinary setting as Gauba presents it; later methodological developments are not silently imported. (PDF pp.118-122)
- FACT: Easton's 1969 post-behavioural intervention is used as a dated intellectual marker inside the book's narrative, not as a present-day disciplinary status claim. (PDF pp.121-122)
- FACT: The examples about India under legal approach are examples of what legal analysis would ask, not a full contemporary constitutional handbook. (PDF pp.115-116)
- WRONG: Do not turn "value-free" into "socially innocent"; the chapter itself shows why that move provoked the post-behavioural correction. (PDF pp.121-122)

13. Sources, metadata and tags

- FACT: Primary source used directly: Gauba, Ch.4, PDF pp.108-134.
- FACT: Method/approach and empirical/normative anchor pages: PDF pp.108-112.
- FACT: Traditional approaches anchor pages: PDF pp.113-117.
- FACT: Behavioural and post-behavioural anchor pages: PDF pp.118-122.
- FACT: Analytical models anchor pages: PDF pp.122-134.
- ANALYSIS: All synthesis beyond direct paraphrase is tagged, especially where the file converts Gauba's narrative into answer-ready matrices.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

ONE-PAGE CONCEPT GRID

Concept / thinker	Exam-ready formulation
Method	The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
Approach	A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
Empirical statement	A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.
Normative statement	A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.
Behaviouralism	A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.
Post-behaviouralism	A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.
Vernon Van Dyke	Clarifies the distinction between approach and method and explains philosophical analysis as conceptual clarification plus evaluation.
Leo Strauss	Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.
Graham Wallas and Arthur Bentley	Early forerunners of behaviouralism who shift attention toward actual behaviour and informal processes.
Charles Merriam	Calls for scientific rigour, interdisciplinarity and behavioural inquiry.
Harold Lasswell	Develops politics as the analysis of power and policy.
David Easton	Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.

CORE REVISION SPINE

- Doctrine reconstruction: method vs approach -> empirical vs normative -> traditional approaches in one line -> behaviouralism's eight tenets (name at least four) -> post-behaviouralism's relevance/action correction.
- Post-behaviouralism kept scientific gains but demanded relevance, action and value-conscious responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)
- The contemporary shift is marked by behaviouralism, post-behaviouralism and several models of political analysis. (PDF pp.117-134)
- Pure science vs relevance: behaviouralism stressed reliable inquiry; post-behaviouralism added action and public responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)
- Post-behaviouralism: relevance, action and responsible value concern without discarding scientific gains. (PDF pp.121-122)
- Post-behaviouralism, associated with Easton's own self-correction, retains the scientific gains of behaviouralism (rigour, verification, technique) but adds two demands: relevance - political science must address urgent public problems (war, poverty, discrimination, injustice) rather than only tractable micro-questions - and action - intellectuals bear responsibility to apply knowledge for social betterment, not merely to accumulate value-neutral findings. (PDF pp.121-122)
- Post-behaviouralism is a corrective within science, not a licence for unexamined activism; relevance still requires disciplined evidence, or it collapses back into the untested moralism political science was trying to escape.
- Behaviouralism pushed political science toward scientific study of actual political behaviour, regularities, verification and quantification. (PDF pp.118-121)
- It introduces the major traditional approaches-philosophical, historical, legal and institutional-and the later behavioural turn. (PDF pp.112-122)
- The traditional approaches are then outlined: philosophical, historical, legal and institutional. (PDF pp.112-117)
- Method vs approach: methods obtain and use data; approaches decide which questions and data count as relevant. (PDF pp.108-109)
- Behaviouralism: scientific study of actual behaviour, eight key tenets, micro-level reliability. (PDF pp.118-121)

HIGH-RISK TRAPS

- Trap repair: Method and approach are synonyms. -> Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
- Trap repair: Traditional always means normative, and contemporary always means empirical. -> Gauba explicitly rejects that mechanical equation. (PDF pp.109-110)
- Trap repair: Any sentence with "ought" is normative. -> Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
- Trap repair: Value-free means politically consequence-free. -> Behavioural inquiry can shape what gets studied and ignored, which is why post-behaviouralism raised the issue of relevance. (PDF pp.121-122)
- Trap repair: Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for activism. -> Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122)

ANSWER SPINE

1. Define the exact doctrine or controversy in the question.
2. State a qualified thesis before narration begins.
3. Reconstruct premises, mechanism and conclusion.
4. Add named thinkers and one precise distinction.
5. Present the strongest objection, reply and residual limitation.
6. End with a graded verdict tied to the directive.